

Date: September 10, 2026

To: Dr. Monika Samra, Assistant Editor
Editorial Office, *npj Artificial Intelligence*
Springer Nature Publishing Group

Subject: Submission of Revised Manuscript (Manuscript ID: 5a3d24b0-5398-4e89-835d-34efbe8bd9e3, Revision v2.3)

Manuscript Title: Financial Time-Series Generation: A Systematic Survey of Taxonomy, Evaluation, Datasets, and Open Challenges

Authors: Yingxiao Zhang, Jiaxin Duan, Yue Zou, Ke Feng*, Jing Xiao*

Dear Dr. Monika Samra and Editorial Team,

Thank you for the technical check feedback regarding our manuscript. We have completed all technical, structural, and editorial revisions required by *npj Artificial Intelligence*. This letter accompanies revision v2.3, in which the two points raised in the most recent technical check—primary subheadings only in Results and Methods, and a marked-up manuscript in red font—have been addressed in full.

In direct compliance with the editorial instructions, we explicitly provide the following formal declarations:

1. Figure Originality and Copyright Declaration:

We formally confirm that **all figures (Figures 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, and 6) included in this manuscript and supplementary materials are original creations by the authors.**

- Figure 1 (Evolution timeline) was custom-designed and generated using LaTeX TikZ.
- Figure 2 (Two-level taxonomy tree) was constructed using LaTeX Forest.
- Figure 3 (Task structural comparison), Figure 4 (Foundation model adaptation paradigms), Figure 5 (Multi-scale synthesis paradigms), and Figure 6 (PRISMA 2020 literature screening flow diagram) were illustrated and plotted directly by the authors using custom scientific diagramming tools.
- **No figure, subpanel, or graphical element has been reproduced, adapted, or taken from third-party publications or copyrighted external sources.** Therefore, no external copyright permissions, licensing fees, or third-party reuse authorizations are required. All displayed elements are entirely original to this submission.

2. IRDM Article Formatting:

The manuscript has been restructured into the mandatory IRDM format (Abstract, Introduction, Results with compulsory subheadings, Discussion without subheadings, Methods with compulsory subheadings, Declarations, sequential Nature-formatted References, Figure Legends and Figures, and Tables).

3. **Primary Subheadings Only in Results and Methods:**

Following your most recent instruction, the Results and Methods sections now contain **only primary subheadings**. All secondary subheadings have been deleted, and all bolded or numbered text that previously appeared under a primary heading—which would itself be regarded as a secondary subheading—has been converted into continuous running prose. Specifically, the itemized and enumerated lists in these sections have been dismantled and rewritten as flowing paragraphs, so that no bolded label, no list marker, and no numbering remains under any primary heading in Results or Methods. Five headings that carried a label but no text of their own have also been removed. Every sentence produced by this restructuring is shown in red in the marked-up manuscript, and a red bracketed marker is placed at each site where a subheading was removed, so that each change can be verified point by point against this letter. The Discussion remains a sequence of paragraphs without subheadings of any level.

4. **Marked-Up Manuscript in Red Font:**

A complete marked-up manuscript (`is26_marked.pdf`) accompanies this revision as a Related File. All changes to the text are shown **in red font** and are visible in any standard PDF reader. **No tracked changes were used and no comments or annotation balloons are included**, in accordance with your instruction that such markup cannot be viewed.

5. **Declaration Statements and System Synchronization:**

All mandatory declarations—including Data Availability, Code Availability, Acknowledgements, Funding, Author Contributions (with author initials unambiguously differentiated: Y. Zhang and Y. Zou), and Competing Interests—are fully incorporated into the main manuscript file and match the text provided in the online SNAPP submission portal verbatim.

6. **Systematic Review Compliance:**

A completed PRISMA 2020 27-item checklist is provided as Supplementary Information (`Supplementary_Information_PRISMA.pdf`).

We have also submitted individual figure files (`Figure1.pdf` through `Figure6.png`) stripped of figure labels and titles, a clean manuscript file (`is26.pdf`), a marked-up manuscript showing all revisions in red font without tracked changes or comments (`is26_marked.pdf`), and a detailed point-by-point response letter (`Response_to_Technical_Check.pdf`). The marked-up file (`is26_marked.pdf`) has been uploaded under the **Related Files** section of the submission portal in PDF format, as requested.

Thank you for your continued guidance and consideration of our revised manuscript.

Sincerely,

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